This soup provides an unexpected, beautiful finale to a meal on a warm summer's day. It comes into its own when a ripe cantaloupe is used.

chilled melon and white wine soup

SERVES 6 **PREP** 10 MINS PLUS 1–2 HRS CHILLING TIME **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

1 cantaloupe or other melon, weighing a generous 2¼lb (1kg)
⅔ cup sugar
1 cup dry white wine
lemon juice
⅔ cup crème fraîche

1 Discard the seeds and scoop the flesh from the melon. Ideally you should have 1½lb (750g) weight, but don't worry if you have more or less. The other quantities can be adjusted to your taste and this will depend more on the strength of the melon's flavor than on its bulk.

2 Dissolve the sugar in 2½ cups of water over low heat, then simmer for 4–5 minutes. Remove from the heat and let cool completely.

3 In a food processor or blender, process the melon with the wine until smooth, then gradually add the cool syrup. Stop when the mixture tastes just a little sweeter than you would ideally like it. Now mix in a few good squeezes of lemon juice and the crème fraîche. Serve chilled, with tiny almond cookies or meringues.